

GUITAR CHORDS BY INTERVALS (SEMITONES)

INTERVALS ARE MEASURED IN SEMITONES FROM THE ROOT (0)

ALL INTERVALS WITHIN ONE OCTAVE

SEMITONES	NAME	ABBREVIATION	EXAMPLE FROM E
0	Perfect Unison	1 (P1)	E
1	Minor 2nd	m2	F
2	Major 2nd	M2	F#
3	Minor 3rd	m3	G
4	Major 3rd	M3	G#
5	Perfect 4th	P4	A
6	Tritone (Aug 4th / Dim 5th)	TT	A# / Bb
7	Perfect 5th	P5	B
8	Minor 6th	m6	C
9	Major 6th	M6	C#
10	Minor 7th	m7	D
11	Major 7th	M7	D#
12	Perfect Octave	8 (P8)	E

HOW TO READ THIS CHART

- Numbers show the distance in semitones from the root (0).
- Example: In E7 = E (0), G# (4), B (7), D (10).
- Play the notes in any order on the guitar.

KEY IDEAS

Building blocks

- Major 3rd = 4
- Minor 3rd = 3
- Perfect 5th = 7
- Minor 7th = 10
- Major 7th = 11

Patterns to know

Major triad	0	4	7	
Minor triad	0	3	7	
Dominant 7	0	4	7	10
Major 7	0	4	7	11

QUICK RULES (MEMORY SHORTCUTS)

- m (minor) → lower the 3rd (4 → 3)
- 7 (dominant) → add b7 (10)
- maj7 → add 7 (11)
- 9 → add 9 (14)
- sus2 / sus4 → replace the 3rd with 2 or 4
- dim → lower the 5th (7 → 6)
- aug → raise the 5th (7 → 8)

TRIADS (3-NOTE CHORDS)

Major	0	4	7
Minor	0	3	7
Diminished	0	3	6
Augmented	0	4	8
Power Chord (5)	0	7	
Sus2	0	2	7
Sus4	0	5	7

SEVENTH CHORDS (4-NOTE)

7 (Dominant)	0	4	7	10
Maj7	0	4	7	11
m7	0	3	7	10
mMaj7	0	3	7	11
dim7	0	3	6	9
m7b5 (Half-Dim)	0	3	6	10

SIXTH CHORDS (4-NOTE)

6	0	4	7	9
m6	0	3	7	9

ADDED-NOTE CHORDS

add9	0	4	7	14	
madd9	0	3	7	14	
6/9	0	4	7	9	14

NINTH CHORDS (5-NOTE)

9 (Dominant 9)	0	4	7	10	14
Maj9	0	4	7	11	14
m9	0	3	7	10	14

ELEVENTH CHORDS (6-NOTE)

11	0	4	7	10	14	17
m11	0	3	7	10	14	17

THIRTEENTH CHORDS (7-NOTE)

13	0	4	7	10	14	17	21
m13	0	3	7	10	14	17	21

THE "ESSENTIAL 10" (START HERE)

1	Major	Happy, bright, stable	0	4	7
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EXAMPLES IN E

CHORD	NOTES	FORMULA
E Major	E G# B	0 4 7

2	Minor	Sad, mellow, darker	0	3	7
3	5 (Power)	Strong, open, rock sound	0	7	
4	Sus2	Open, unresolved	0	2	7
5	Sus4	Open, suspended	0	5	7
6	7 (Dominant)	Bluesy, wants to resolve	0	4	7 10
7	Maj7	Smooth, jazzy	0	4	7 11
8	m7	Warm, jazzy, soulful	0	3	7 10
9	dim	Tense, unstable	0	3	6
10	add9	Full, lush	0	4	7 14

CHORD	NOTES	FORMULA
E Minor	E G B	0 3 7
E5	E B	0 7
E7	E G# B D	0 4 7 10
Emaj7	E G# B D#	0 4 7 11
Em7	E G B D	0 3 7 10
E9	E G# B D F#	0 4 7 10 14
Eadd9	E G# B F#	0 4 7 14

💡 THINK IN **INTERVALS**,
NOT JUST SHAPES.

🎸 SAME FORMULA.
ANY ROOT NOTE.

PRACTICE. LISTEN.
MAKE MUSIC! 🎵